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INDUSTRY TALK REPORT

**TITLE : Bridging Data & Decisions: The Role of Data Governance and Data Management
in Modern Business Intelligence**

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1.0 Introduction

The talk "Bridging Data & Decisions: The Role of Data Governance and Data Management in Modern Business Intelligence" was given by Faiz Fabillah, who works in Enterprise Data and AI Governance at Perbadanan Insurans Deposit Malaysia (PIDM). He has more than 15 years of experience across different industries, including financial services, manufacturing and oil and gas. He is also a board member (VP Secretariat) of DAMA Kuala Lumpur and Selangor and holds an MSc in Business Analytics from Imperial College London.

The aim of the talk was to explain why good data governance and data management are the base of trustworthy Business Intelligence (BI). The speaker pointed out that whatever rules we set for data will also control the analytics and AI built on top of it. This topic is very relevant to BI and Analytics because dashboards, reports and models are only as good as the data behind them. Governance is what makes that data correct and proves that it can be trusted.

2.0 Key Takeaways

Why data governance matters

The speaker showed that bad data is a real and costly problem. He shared that about 73% of company data is never used, only around 3% meets basic quality standards and poor data quality costs companies about USD 12.9 million a year on average. A key idea was being able to prove that the data in a report is accurate. He also noted some common problems:

- Companies often avoid spending on data quality and checks are done by hand, which is slow and must be repeated as data grows.
- Joining data across departments is hard because teams use different definitions, so it's unclear which version is true.
- Compliance should come before visualization, since a dashboard built on wrong data leads to bad decisions. Dashboards should also stay private unless sharing is allowed.

In short, governance tells you how to handle data correctly. Without it, nothing built on the data can be trusted.

Governance versus management

Management is the work that increases the value of data as an asset, while governance sets the policies and rules for it. This means governance sets the direction and checks results, while management carries out the work. He also explained the main roles are data owner, data steward and data user.

He introduced the DAMA framework of eleven data management areas, noting that a company does not need all of them at once. It can pick the areas that fit its needs or use all of them for full-scale work.

Tools and concepts mentioned

- Six dimensions of data quality which are uniqueness, validity, accuracy, timeliness, consistency and completeness.
- Metadata which means information that describes data. Raising awareness of it leads to more analytics and data use.
- Data lineage that tracks data from its source to the final report, which makes problems easier to fix.
- Data cataloguing by marketing the data so people know it exists and use it more.
- Master data management which is one single source of truth shared across departments. Reference and master data rarely change, while transactional data changes often.

3.0 Reflection and Critical Insights

Each member took away something different from the talk.

Mohamed Alif Fathi

I believe that the data quality numbers to be the most surprising information found during the talk. The idea that only about 3% of data meets basic standards while bad data costs millions makes governance feel like an economical problem, not just a technical one. This linked to the data warehousing and ETL topics in class, showing that cleaning and transforming data are important business processes with real cost and risk.

Iman Abadi Bin Mohd Nizwan

I think that the most interesting part is the idea that compliance should come before visualization. Most people used to think a nice dashboard was the main goal of BI, but realised a good-looking dashboard built on bad data can mislead people. This connected to the class topic on the BI lifecycle and having one single source of truth, especially in regulated fields like finance.

Muhammad Naim

I found that the ideas of metadata, lineage and data cataloguing, especially marketing data inside a company was interesting. This matched what was learned in class about metadata, but added a useful point. Data is only valuable when people know it's there and trust it.

4.0 Conclusion

Overall, the talk gave us a useful new view of BI. It shifted our focus from the final output, like dashboards, to the governance and management work that makes those outputs trustworthy. The speaker's real examples made a difficult topic easy to follow.

It also widened our view of career paths, showing that data governance and analytics engineering are growing fields that mix technical skills with business knowledge. It encouraged us to pay more attention to data quality, metadata and frameworks like DAMA in our future studies and work.